

THE CANADIAN JETSETTER

The Pre-Flight Checklist for Flying With Your Pet in Canada

Everything you need to do before, during, and at the airport so your trip goes smoothly.



My dog Pluto and I

Hey! Thanks for downloading the
**Pre-Flight Checklist for Flying With Your
Pet in Canada.**

Flying with a pet in Canada is totally doable, but the information out there is all over the place. This checklist cuts through the noise so you know exactly what to do before, at the airport, and on the plane.

Cheers to travelling with your furry friend!

Graeme Bligh. The Canadian Jetsetter

WEEKS BEFORE YOUR FLIGHT

- ☐ **Call your airline** to add your pet to the booking. Do not wait, spots are limited.
- ☐ Confirm the pet fee: expect around **\$50 CAD each way** on most major Canadian airlines.
- ☐ Check your aircraft type. Look for the **CRJ900 or Dash 8** if possible — no centre bar under the seat.
- ☐ Book a vet appointment and confirm **vaccinations are up to date.**
- ☐ Ask your vet about **Trazodone** for in-flight anxiety. It calms without sedating.
- ☐ Get an **expandable soft-sided carrier** if you do not already have one.
- ☐ Start **kennel training** using treats and positive reinforcement every session.



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DAYS BEFORE YOUR FLIGHT

- ☐ **Get your dog groomed.** A fresh cut can make your dog look noticeably smaller at check-in.
- ☐ Do a **full carrier fit check** with your dog inside to confirm comfort.
- ☐ Pack a **small blanket** to tuck alongside the carrier for cold cabin air.
- ☐ Pack a **portable mini fan** for warm, low-airflow conditions under the seat.
- ☐ If using Trazodone, **confirm timing and dosage** with your vet ahead of travel day.

AT THE AIRPORT

- ☐ **Arrive early** and get your dog settled in the carrier before approaching check-in. Keep your dog calm and contained before the gate agent sees you.
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- ☐ **Do not rely on indoor pet relief stations.** Find an outdoor area if possible, even if it means re-clearing security. Plan extra time for this.
- ☐ Once onboard, store the carrier **under the seat** and keep your dog inside for taxi, takeoff, and landing.

Want to learn more on travelling with your furry friend?
Check out my blog about this topic [here](#).